

OLIVIA POLSKY

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Education

Cornell University, Duffield College of Engineering

Ithaca, NY

B.S. Mechanical Engineering

Anticipated Graduation: May 2028

Relevant Courses: Introduction to Mechanical Design, Dynamics, Statics and Mechanics of Solids, Thermodynamics, Electricity and Magnetism, Mechanics and Heat, Oscillations, Waves, and Quantum Physics

Relevant Experience

Concrete Canoe Project Team

Ithaca, NY

Mix Subteam Member

Fall 2024 - Present

- Design lightweight structural and aesthetics, high-strength concrete mixes by varying water–cement ratio, admixtures, aggregates, and reinforcement additives to meet strength-to-weight targets.
- Prepare and cast test specimens and perform compressive and flexural testing; document results and iterate on mix design based on performance.

Cornell University Visitor Relations

Ithaca, NY

Information Specialist/Tour Guide

Spring 2025 - Present

- Deliver campus tours, adjusting content for different audiences while maintaining clear, professional communication.
- Operate the university switchboard and prioritize/triage calls, ensuring accurate routing and timely support to offices and services.

Longford's Ice Cream

Larchmont, NY

Shift Lead

Summer 2022 - Present

- Lead shift operations by assigning tasks, training new employees, and ensuring smooth workflow during peak hours.
 - Handle cash management (register closeout, balancing drawers) and support accurate daily reporting.
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Research Experience

Department of Psychology

University of Illinois, Urbana-Champaign

Research Intern

2022

- Summarized participant data using JASP(means/SD, distributions) and compared groups to support ongoing research on personality and social-emotional traits.
- Performed data quality checks (missingness, outliers, inconsistent entries), prepared analysis-ready datasets, and collaborated with the research team to interpret results and refine next steps.

Pelham Memorial High School

Pelham, NY

Independent Researcher

2024

- Developed a lab procedure to extract cellulose from coffee filters using 1,5-diazabicyclo[4.3.0]non-5-ene (DBN) for potential textile-fiber applications.
- Executed trials and recorded results, compared outcomes across iterations, and analyzed data to improve reproducibility.

Honors & Awards: Somers Science Fair (1st Place, 2022), Behavioral Science & Engineering Fair (4th Place, 2023), IBM Visionary Engineering Award (2024)

Community Service and Leadership

Letters for Rose

2020 - Present

- Founded and led the Pelham chapter of Letters for Rose; coordinated letter drives and deliveries to nursing-home residents to support seniors experiencing isolation.

National Charity League (NCL), Westchester, NY

2022 - 2024

- Served as Member Recognition Chair (2022) and Secretary (2023) while completing 100+ philanthropy hours across local charities and community organizations.

New York City Book Drives

2022 - 2024

- Spearheaded and hand-distributed over 4,000 surplus books from the NCL Book Drive to seed a New York City charter school in Queens and PS 9 in the Bronx of which had outdated and irrelevant library books.
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Skills: CAD, Python, JASP/SPSS, Matlab

Interests: Guitar, Crocheting/Knitting, Running, Field Hockey